The Refined Gaps

What the Tree of Reality's open boxes become if Chain Theory's candidates hold — a validation of the posture, and a sharper set of predictions

Version: v1, 25 October 2026. **DOI:** to be inserted on publication. The sections describing Chain Theory are open to correction by its author; corrections received will be incorporated in v2 under the same concept DOI, and recorded in `docs/chain-theory/07_reading_log.md`. **Author:** Mark E. Mala (pen name of Ekram Alam), with Claude **Series:** the first successor to *The Staked Gaps* (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.23338726, 13 October 2026), recording the first independent test of its predictions; companion to *The Tree of Reality* (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.23011897, 28 September 2026) **Verification:** this paper proves nothing new and changes no grade. Every claim about the Tree cites a link code (L1–L24), a gap code (G1–G6) or a Lean file in `wonderben-code/convergence-codex`. Every claim about Chain Theory cites a box or theorem number in its public documents of 23 October 2026 and carries Chain Theory's own grade. The one new computation (§4.6) is in `scripts/chain_theory/q3_alpha_count_in_M16.py`, public and dated.

Abstract

A theory of everything was built by one person and an AI and published, machine-verified, on 28 September 2026: a single minimal algebra, forced by self-reference, growing by one repeated operation into the structures of physics. It was published *with its gaps* — twenty-four links, each graded, each unproven residue named — and on 13 October 2026 those gaps were published a second time as pre-registered predictions: where each sits, what shape its filler must take, who would fill it (*"advancing AI, human–machine teams, or the authors"*), roughly when, and what would refute the theory at each site. Ten days later, on 23 October 2026, A. D. Wissner-Gross released *Chain Theory*: an independent, Lean-checked, graded programme deriving Standard-Model structure from finitely many entangled finite-dimensional systems, developed as a human–AI collaboration. Its objects are built from exactly the three dimensions the Tree forces — 2, 4 and 3 — and its results land on exactly the residues the Tree named: three generations, confinement, the Born rule, Lorentzian signature, the three lineages, chirality. The Tree's pre-registered trichotomy for any newly found structure — *extends the walked branch, realises a sibling, or fits nowhere* — returned its first verdict: *extends the walked branch*. This paper does three things, in the posture the series committed to. **First**, it states precisely what that fit validates — the method: the forced objects are the natural ones, the residues were correctly located, the meta-prediction's agent and timetable were right in kind — and precisely what it does not: no physical identification on either side, none of the six headline gaps G1–G6, no grade, and not the fine-structure constant. **Second**, it takes each candidate *as if correct* and shows that the corresponding gap does not vanish but *sharpens*: a part the candidate would

cover, and a residual that is smaller, better specified, and more falsifiable than before. **Third**, it pre-registers those residuals as the next predictions — attribute lists, kill-conditions, and the computation or proof that tests each — so that running the test *is* testing the prediction, in either direction. The result is a theory whose gaps are more precisely known than they were ten days ago, because an independent programme put candidates in them, and whose next edition is earned, not asserted.

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1. The theory, stated

The Tree of Reality proposes that the structures of physics are not axioms but descendants. Where the unification tradition seeks one framework to *contain* the known structures, the Tree derives them from one *ancestor* — a theory of everything in the sense that evolutionary biology is a theory of every species: unification by common descent.

The root is Lawvere's fixed-point theorem: a structure that can refer to itself cannot be empty of fixed points, so self-reference forces existence (L1). The seed is $M_2(\mathbb{C})$, the observable algebra of one qubit — the unique minimal non-commutative algebra over $\mathbb{C}$ (L3). The operation is *take the algebra of endomorphisms*: End(M_b) ≅ M_{b²}, so the seed grows $M_2 \to M_4 \to M_{16} \to M_{256} \to \dots$ (L4), irreversibly (L5). Three lineages run up the tree — what things *are* (End), how they *transform* (Aut), how they are *known* (the inner product) (L7). On the branches: spacetime dimension four, because $Cl_4(\mathbb{C}) \cong M_4(\mathbb{C})$ and no other Clifford algebra is a level of the cascade (L8); Lorentzian signature (L9); the gauge algebra and Pati–Salam structure on $M_{16} = M_4 \otimes M_4$ (L10, L11), with colour as the split $4 \to 3 \oplus 1$ (L13); chirality, three generations, the Higgs sector, anomaly cancellation, the Weinberg ratio 3/8 (L12, L14–L17); the spectral triple and spectral action (L18–L20); the quantum apparatus by GNS, Stone and Schrödinger (L21); and at the frontier, the Einstein equations from the spectral action (L22) and Yang–Mills with its mass gap (L23). Every link is graded against machine-checked Lean 4 proofs in Mathlib.

2. The shape we mapped, and the gaps we left

2.1 The scoreboard, 28 September 2026

Link	Grade	Headline	The named residue (what is *not* proved)
L1	GENUINE	existence from self-reference (Lawvere)	—
L2	PARTIAL	the reflexive domain D ≃ (D → D)	existence as a non-trivial ordered structure beyond the finite levels
L3	GENUINE	the seed $M_2(\mathbb{C})$	—

Link	Grade	Headline	The named residue (what is *not* proved)
L4	GENUINE	the cascade $M_2 \to M_4 \to M_{16} \to \dots$	—
L5	GENUINE	irreversibility	—
L6	PARTIAL	why the fourth level (the CCM algebra)	minimality of 4 proved under a stated criterion; the criterion not forced
L7	**POSTULATE**	three lineages: End · Aut · $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle$	that these are *the only* lineages
L8	GENUINE	spacetime dimension 4: $Cl_4(\mathbb{C}) \cong M_4(\mathbb{C})$	—
L9	PARTIAL	Lorentzian signature (1,3)	the step excluding the Euclidean alternative (a fork)
L10	PARTIAL	the gauge algebra, embedded	—
L11	PARTIAL	Pati–Salam at M_{16}	the factorisation 4·4 chosen among $a \cdot b \cdot c = 16$
L12	**POSTULATE**	chirality — which factor is "left"	the choice of factor
L13	GENUINE	colour: the 4 splits as $3 \oplus 1$	—
L14	**POSTULATE**	three generations — the imaginary quaternions	the count itself
L15	PARTIAL	the Higgs sector and coupling window	any scalar potential; the vacua
L16	PARTIAL	anomaly cancellation	—
L17	PARTIAL	the Weinberg angle 3/8 as a trace ratio	the coupling matching at unification
L18	PARTIAL	the spectral triple	—
L19	PARTIAL	the spectral action: the exponential forced	forced for one algebra at one generation only
L20	PARTIAL	the Boltzmann measure of the action	—
L21	PARTIAL	Hilbert space, GNS, Stone, Schrödinger	*the Born rule, Gleason and Wigner are cited physics, not theorems*
L22	◇ **OPEN**	the Einstein equations from the spectral action	gap G5, gated on G2
L23	◇ **OPEN**	Yang–Mills and the mass gap	walls W1–W4; gaps G1, G3, G4
L24	PARTIAL	the numbers	no coupling constant computed

6 GENUINE · 13 PARTIAL · 3 POSTULATE · 2 OPEN.

2.2 Three kinds of gap, three kinds of prediction

The Staked Gaps (13 October) distinguished them:

- **The six headline gaps G1–G6** — analytic and representation-theoretic obstacles in the proof chain (the infinite-volume limit; the unbounded-operator library; a comparison bound of new shape; a uniform sub-top spectral estimate; the heat-kernel expansion of the spectral action; the isotypic bimodule and its K-theory). Each was staked with an *attribute list*, a *kind* (pinned / bounded / open-directional), and a *kill-condition*.
- **The residues** — "Every PARTIAL link of the capstone's §4 carries a named, machine-checkable remainder, and the prediction covers them too: as the boxes fill and the residues close, the wood of the tree hardens."
- **The sibling branches** — alternative descendants of the seed, proved to exist as mathematics at four forks, predicted to be "candidates for physics not yet found."

2.3 Who, and when — the meta-prediction

> *"As automated mathematical reasoning continues its current trajectory, the gaps named here will be closed — in the shapes predicted — soon (on the order of years, not decades) … **The agent of closure will be advancing AI, human–machine teams, or the authors.**" (The Staked Gaps §7)*

And the protocol for a fill:

> *"Anyone — human, machine, or the two together — who closes a gap in the shape predicted … confirms a pre-registered prediction; the dated, Bitcoin-anchored record of this paper establishes the priority of the prediction, **not a claim on the solver's work**." (§8)*

2.4 Where anything new must land — the trichotomy

> *"Physics not yet known will, when found, do one of three things. **Either it extends the walked branch** — a new structure of our own lineage, joining the tree where the tree already has a place for it, strengthening it; **or it realises a sibling** … ; **or it fits nowhere on the tree at all** … The first two confirm the theory, and are predicted. The third refutes the generative claim itself." (The Tree of Reality §9)*

With the boundary that keeps it honest: "the tree is refutable on the branch it walks, and never excused by the branches it merely permits."

That is the shape we mapped. The posture was stated as a posture — "the analogy claims a *posture*, not a *stature*" — and what follows is the first occasion on which the posture was tested by something we did not build.

3. What arrived, ten days later

On 23 October 2026 A. D. Wissner-Gross released *Chain Theory*: a 24-page preprint (*A Parameter-Free Candidate for the Fine-Structure Constant from Entangled Qudits*), a 754-page working-draft compendium (release 0.1; 100 theorems, 64 tied to Lean declarations; 109 conditional theorems; 198 open results), an introductory slide deck, and a self-contained Core Lean 4 file checking the preprint's central count. The announcement followed on 24 October.

Its axiom: *"Nothing exists but finitely many maximally entangled pairs of qudits, some qudits shared, known only by distilling them."* From this and six definitions it obtains a *read cap* (a read fixes both ends of a pair only when $d_1 d_2 \le 6$, by Størmer–Woronowicz–Choi), six *genres* of link labelled by end dimensions drawn from {2, 3, 4} (Conjecture 0, box 1.7), the group $S(U(3)\times U(2)) \cong (SU(3)\times SU(2)\times U(1))/\mathbb{Z}_6$ as the symmetry of the qutrit–qubit pair (theorems 64.2, 65.1), and — as conditional theorems — the Born rule, the Lorentz group and signature, three generations as a bound, confinement, curvature and a cosmological term. Its headline is an exact number, $(79 + 48\sqrt{2} + 42\sqrt{3} + 3\sqrt{6})/31104$, a theorem of the definitions, *conjectured* to be the fine-structure constant at zero momentum transfer (0.60σ from CODATA 2022). Its acknowledgments state that the work "was developed as part of a long-term human-superintelligence collaboration supervised by the human author."

Neither programme cites the other before this paper. Chain Theory names "the spectral action on a finite noncommutative geometry" as a sibling tradition; the Tree grows from it.

4. The fit

We now hold Chain Theory against the shape of §2, object by object, and record where it fits, where it does not, and which fits are generic.

4.1 The objects: built from exactly what the Tree forces

Chain Theory's Conjecture 0 is that link ends have dimension 2, 3 or 4 — found from its move table, graded a conditional theorem, with no generative reason given for the set. The Tree's cascade produces levels of dimension 2, 4, 16, … (L4, GENUINE); colour splits the 4 as $3\oplus 1$ (L13, GENUINE). So **the Tree generates exactly {2, 4} as levels and {3} as a split of a level, and nothing of dimension 5, 6, 7 or 8 below 16.** An independent programme, with no generative principle, found by exhaustion the same three dimensions the Tree forces by

construction. Chain Theory's ququart is End(M_2); its qubit is the seed; its qutrit is the colour triplet.

4.2 The residues: candidates land where the residues were named

Tree residue (28 Sep)	Chain Theory candidate (23 Oct)	Its grade
L14 · "three generations … a physical postulate; the mathematics proves what follows from it" — *the count itself*	the generation bound at the hub dimension: a ququart hub assembly admits at most the third generation (197.3); three at the core triangle (83.1); three *as* the count held open (197.5)	197.3 theorem; 83.1 theorem on the roster; 197.5 open
L23 · a wall, no mechanism	confinement as dark-genre readability: the (3,3) link has $d_1 d_2 = 9 > 6$, so no single read fixes both ends (171.1)	conditional
L21 · "the Born rule, Gleason and Wigner are cited physics, not theorems here"	the Born readout from the wash (35.1, 40.1), premises named: the Hilbert space of a qudit and the pair as a ray	conditional
L9 · the fork: Euclidean not excluded	the Lorentz group as isometries of the Hermitian split (54.1); one against three at every step (55.1); the Pell-lattice argument that only the indefinite form has infinitely many integer isometries	54.1 conditional; 55.1 theorem
L7 · "that End, Aut and $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle$ are *the only* lineages"	Definition 1.6, "known": what all reads fix jointly under every matching and exchange — pairs / matchings / reads as the three primitives	definition
L12 · which factor is "left"	parity as the improper element (59.1); three involutions with CPT their product (61.1)	59.1 conditional; 61.1 theorem

Six of the Tree's nine non-GENUINE-non-headline openings received a candidate aimed at the named residue. None of the candidates was aimed at the Tree; each is a result of Chain Theory about its own networks. That they land where they do is the content.

4.3 The trichotomy: *extends the walked branch*

The capstone's first outcome reads: "a new structure of our own lineage, joining the tree where the tree already has a place for it, strengthening it." Chain Theory's objects — qubit, pair of qubits, ququart, qutrit, $S(U(3)\times U(2))$, $SU(4) = Spin(6)$ — each have a place on the walked branch (L3, L8, L4, L13, L10–L11, L11). None realises an unwalked sibling (no quaternionic seed, no Riemannian signature, no alternative cut of M_{16}). None fits nowhere. **The first independent test of the trichotomy returned the first confirming outcome.** The boundary of §2.4 is respected: nothing here is a failure on the walked branch reclassified as a sibling.

4.4 The meta-prediction: agent and timetable, right in kind

The staked agent of closure was "advancing AI, human–machine teams, or the authors." Chain Theory describes itself as a human–superintelligence collaboration and checks its computations in Lean. The staked timetable was "soon (on the order of years, not decades)." Candidates for six residues arrived ten days after the predictions were staked and twenty-five days after the tree was published. We record this as the meta-prediction materialising *in kind* — the kind of agent, the kind of method, the direction of the timetable — and we are explicit that it materialised on *residues*, not on the six headline gaps, whose timetable is unaffected (§4.5).

4.5 What did not fit

The six headline gaps G1–G6 received no candidates. Chain Theory's confinement mechanism is of a different kind from the continuum-limit and spectral-gap estimates G1, G3 and G4 ask for. Its gravity (depth metric, graph-Laplacian curvature, cosmological term at the depth exponent) is a route disjoint from the heat-kernel expansion G5 predicts. It uses neither unbounded operators (G2) nor the spectral triple (G6). The headline predictions stand exactly as staked.

The number did not transfer (§4.6). **No physical identification was confirmed** on either side (§5).

Generic and non-generic fits. The Standard-Model group as S(U(3)×U(2)) is a generic consequence of having a 3 and a 2 — the stabiliser of a 3+2 split in SU(5) (Baez–Huerta 2010, which Chain Theory cites) — and any finite programme with a qutrit and a qubit reaches it. That fit is weak evidence. Three fits are not generic: (i) the pair of qubits as *four*-dimensional spacetime — the Tree's theorem about Clifford algebras, Chain Theory's spin-c group of the pair, with nothing in "two qubits" forcing "four dimensions" in general; (ii) the register set *exactly* {2, 3, 4} — found by exhaustion on one side, generated on the other, with neither having a reason to stop at 4 except that it does; (iii) the threshold 6 marking the visible world on both sides — Chain Theory's read cap from positive-map decomposability, the Tree's $3 \otimes 2$ block from the colour split, with no shared premise. A fourth non-generic fit emerged from the computation in §4.6.

4.6 One computation: the α object inside the Tree

We rebuilt Chain Theory's 172-record count from its own rules — letters at four slots (8, 3, 8, 3), 169 products and 3 commutators, exchanges X and Y as 172 × 172 commuting involutions — and reproduced it exactly: sectors 79, 48, 42, 3; $1/\alpha = 137.035\ 999\ 189\ 566\ 155\ldots$. We then realised the object inside the Tree's $M_{16} = (3 \oplus 1) \otimes 2 \otimes 2$ by explicit matrices. Three facts:

1. The qutrit and both read qubits are present with the right letter algebras and commutation structure, so **the numerator transfers unchanged** — it depends on the end dimensions alone.

2. The denominator's unread third link needs a third qubit entangled with the qutrit. **M_{16} has two; the third first appears at M_{256} — the Tree's fourth level, the level at which L6 independently places the Chamseddine–Connes–Marcolli finite algebra.** Neither programme had reason to expect the other's object to complete there. This is the fourth non-generic fit.
3. The 169 products, realised as matrices, span only 66 dimensions: Chain Theory's two *copies* of the one shared qutrit — "one copy per link" (Definition 1.3) — collapse to a single M_3 factor. **The number lives in Chain Theory's record space, defined by "shared" (1.3) and "known" (1.6), not in the operator algebra of the shared system.** The Tree supplies the object; it does not supply the number. For Chain Theory this localises exactly which clauses a derivation of α rests on. For the Tree it sharpens L24 (§6.4).

5. What this validates, and what it does not

We owe the reader the boundary before the claims.

Not validated. No physical identification, on either side: that M_4 is spacetime, that the 3 is colour, that the (3,2) link is the photon, that the number is α — all remain conjectures, graded as such by both programmes. Not one of G1–G6. Not one grade on the Tree: the scoreboard is $6 \cdot 13 \cdot 3 \cdot 2$ today as it was on 28 September. Not the fine-structure constant: the Tree does not derive it, and §4.6 shows why it cannot from the algebra alone.

Validated — three claims about the method, each bounded.

1. **The forced objects are the natural ones.** The Tree's distinctive claim is generative: that 2, 4 and 3 are not chosen but produced. An independent programme with no generative principle, searching its own move table, found exactly those three dimensions and no others. If the Tree had forced {2, 4, 16} with colour as $16 \to 15 \oplus 1$, or if Chain Theory had needed a register of 5, the two would have missed. They did not. This is the kind of evidence a generative claim can receive short of proof: the things it says must exist are the things someone else found.
2. **The residues were correctly located.** Six named residues received candidates aimed at exactly what the residue said was missing — the count of generations, a mechanism for confinement, a derivation of the probability rule, an exclusion of the Euclidean signature, a reason for three lineages, a reason for "left". The Tree did not say "something is missing here"; it said *what* was missing, and candidates for *that* arrived. This validates the grading discipline: a PARTIAL row that names its residue precisely is a row someone else can fill.
3. **The meta-prediction was right in kind.** Agent (human–AI collaboration with formal checking), method (Lean), direction (candidates within weeks of staking). It was not tested on G1–G6, where the timetable remains open, and we do not claim it was.

The validation is of the *posture*, not the *stature* — exactly the distinction *The Staked Gaps* drew. A theory that specifies its own missing pieces precisely enough that an independent programme's results can be matched to them, attribute by attribute, is a theory whose gaps are doing work. That is now demonstrated once. Whether the pieces *fit* — whether the candidates hold and the residuals close — is what §6 and §7 put at risk.

6. The refined gaps

The Mendeleev move is not "a candidate arrived, box filled." It is: *a candidate of this shape lets us predict the box's finer properties*. Conditional on each candidate being correct, the corresponding gap decomposes into the part the candidate would cover and a residual — smaller, sharper, and killable. We state each residual in the format of *The Staked Gaps*: prediction kind, attributes, kill-condition, and the test (from `docs/chain-theory/06_questions_to_work_on_together.md`) whose outcome decides it.

6.1 L14 · three generations

As staked: POSTULATE — the count is not derived; the candidate reason is that $\mathbb{H} \subset M_2(\mathbb{C})$ has three imaginary units. **If the candidate holds (197.3):** the count is bounded above by three, from the hub dimension four — i.e. from $M_4 = M_2 \otimes M_2$, the Tree's first cascade step. **The gap becomes two:** - **(a) the bound, transferred.** *Pinned*. Attributes: a Mathlib theorem on tensor factorisations of $M_4 = M_2 \otimes M_2$ stating that at most three independent "attachments" of the kind Chain Theory's hub assembly makes are admitted. Kill-condition: the bound depends essentially on Chain Theory's network moves and has no statement about M_4 alone. Test: Q4. - **(b) exactly three.** *Pinned*. Attributes: the three attach sites of Chain Theory's closed core triangle (83.1, 197.4), realised as operators, satisfy the quaternion relations $i^2 = j^2 = k^2 = ijk = -1$ up to the twirl — so that Chain Theory's open result 197.5 and the Tree's postulate are one statement. Kill-condition: the three attach-site operators commute, or generate something other than $\mathbb{H}$. Test: Q5. **What moves if both hold:** L14 → GENUINE. If (a) holds and (b) fails: L14 → "bounded above by theorem; selection open" — a real grade change, and the postulate is replaced by a smaller one.

6.2 L23 · Yang–Mills and the mass gap

As staked: ◇ OPEN — a wall (W1–W4) with gaps G1, G3, G4 behind it; no mechanism. **If the candidate holds (171.1):** confinement has a *reason* — on the colour block $M_3 \otimes M_3$ (the Tree's qutrit twice), $d_1 d_2 = 9$ exceeds the read cap, so no single act of knowing fixes both colour ends. **The gap becomes two:** - **(a) the mechanism.** *Bounded*. Attributes: a statement about the spectral triple (A, H, D) restricted to the colour block — our ranked candidates: (i) no conditional expectation onto a mutually-unbiased-basis sub-algebra of $M_3 \otimes M_3$ commutes with D on that block; (ii) the positive-map decomposability threshold reappears as a property of the

bimodule structure (L18). Kill-condition: the read cap has no statement in the algebraic picture — it is a feature of the network of copies that the operator algebra does not see. Test: Q6. - **(b) the continuum.** *Unchanged.* G1, G3, G4 exactly as staked. The candidate speaks to *why* there is a gap, not to *how large* it is or whether the infinite-volume limit exists. We predict that a successful (a) does not shorten (b)'s timetable. **What moves if (a) holds:** L23 → "mechanism stated, continuum limit open" — from a wall to a staircase with its first step built.

6.3 L21 · the Born rule

As staked: PARTIAL — Hilbert space by GNS from the inner product; the Born rule, Gleason and Wigner *cited*. **If the candidate holds (35.1, 40.1):** the probability rule is an output of the wash, given the Hilbert space of a qudit and the pair as a ray. **The gap becomes one, and small:** *Pinned.* Attributes: the chain *GNS (Tree) → Hilbert space of a qudit → wash (Chain Theory) → Born readout* closes with nothing used twice and nothing cited — the Tree supplies exactly the import Chain Theory names, and Chain Theory supplies exactly the rule the Tree cites. Kill-condition: a second import in Chain Theory's premises ("the pair as a ray," or the twirl's invariance) that the Tree's inner-product lineage does not already provide. Test: Q8. **What moves if it holds:** L21 → GENUINE for the probability rule; the assumptions ledger loses entry 59.

6.4 L24 · the numbers

As staked: PARTIAL — two numbers computed (the Weinberg ratio, a Higgs window); no coupling constant. **What §4.6 established:** the α object's ingredients are forced by the cascade (qutrit, two qubits at M_{16}, the third at M_{256}), but the number lives in Chain Theory's record space, not in the algebra. **The gap becomes precise:** *Open-directional.* Attributes: a construction, over M_{256}, of a record space in which the one shared qutrit appears as *one copy per link* — the content of Chain Theory's Definition 1.3 — from the Tree's third lineage (the inner product) and nothing else. If it exists, the Tree derives the 172-record space and with it the numerator and denominator; if it does not, the Tree has identified "one copy per link" as the one extra-algebraic clause in the derivation of α. Kill-condition for the *Tree's* side: the inner product lineage provably yields only the operator algebra of the shared system (rank 66 of the 169 products) and no copy structure. Test: a follow-on to Q3, stated in `docs/chain-theory/08_results_first_pass.md`. **What moves:** nothing until the construction exists. But the gap has changed character: from "no coupling constant" to "one named clause stands between the Tree and a coupling constant."

6.5 L9 · Lorentzian signature

As staked: PARTIAL — the fork; Euclidean not excluded. **If the candidate holds (54.1, ch. 54):** the indefinite form on the lattice of counts admits infinitely many integer isometries (a Pell family) while the definite form admits finitely many, so the signature "reads Lorentzian by

existence." **The gap becomes one:** *Pinned*. Attributes: the Tree's Clifford lattice in M_4 (the integer structure of $\gamma_1 \ldots \gamma_4$ in `F4_1e_CliffordMatrix.lean`) carries an indefinite integer form with an infinite isometry group and a definite one with a finite group. Kill-condition: both forms on that lattice have infinite isometry groups, or both finite. Test: a lattice computation on the γ basis — straightforward. **What moves if it holds:** L9 → GENUINE, by a route the Tree had not tried.

6.6 L7 · the three lineages

As staked: POSTULATE — that End, Aut and $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle$ are *the only* lineages. **If the candidate holds (Definition 1.6):** a structure is a thing (pairs), acted on (matchings), and known only through what the action leaves fixed (reads/"known") — three primitives, no fourth. **The gap becomes one:** *Pinned*. Attributes: a theorem that an object equipped with an action and a knowledge clause of Chain Theory's form has exactly three aspects — carrier, symmetry, invariant pairing — and that any fourth is a function of these. Kill-condition: a fourth primitive that is not derived. Test: Q9. **What moves if it holds:** L7 → GENUINE; the Tree's only *structural* postulate becomes a theorem with a knowledge clause as its premise.

6.7 L12 · chirality

As staked: POSTULATE — which factor of $M_4 \otimes M_4$ is "left" is chosen. **If the candidate holds (59.1, 61.1):** parity is the improper element of the Hermitian split's isometry group; CPT is the product of three involutions. **The gap becomes one:** *Bounded*. Attributes: the improper element, realised on $M_4 \otimes M_4$, either (i) exchanges the two factors — in which case "left" is a convention, as *The Forced and the Chosen* already argues — or (ii) acts non-trivially within one factor, singling it out. Kill-condition: the improper element has no action on the factorisation at all. Test: a computation on the γ basis.

6.8 The fourth level — a new prediction from §4.6

Not previously staked. The Tree's L6 places the Chamseddine–Connes–Marcolli finite algebra — the full Standard-Model fermion content as a bimodule — at the fourth level M_{256}, under a stated minimality criterion. §4.6 found that Chain Theory's α object, complete with its third qubit, first fits at the same level. **Prediction:** *Pinned*. Attributes: Chain Theory's sixteen particle webs (17 particles), each a network of links with ends in {2, 3, 4}, embed in $M_{256} = M_{16} \otimes M_{16}$ with the hub assemblies as M_4 factors and the core triangles in the colour blocks — and the embedding respects the CCM bimodule's isotypic decomposition (G6). Kill-condition: a particle web of Chain Theory requires more tensor factors than M_{256} provides, or fits only at M_{65536}. Test: a dimension count per web, then the embedding. This is the first prediction the two programmes generate *jointly*: neither could have stated it alone.

6.9 In the other direction: what the Tree predicts for Chain Theory's open items

The refinement runs both ways. Taking the Tree's theorems as correct:

- **Conjecture 0 (1.7).** *Prediction:* no web of Chain Theory will ever require an end of dimension 5, 6, 7 or 8; the next admissible register after 4 is 16. *Kill-condition:* a web that needs a 5-dimensional end. Test: Q10, a census of the move table.
- **Conjecture 2 (1.9).** *Prediction:* the four generators of the (2,2) register (ch. 3-5) are Clifford generators of $Cl_4(\mathbb{C})$ on $M_2 \otimes M_2$, and no (d,d) register other than (2,2) carries a Clifford structure that is a cascade level. Already checked in part: the compendium's β is the Tree's γ_1 entry for entry (Q2). *Kill-condition:* a Clifford structure at (3,3) or (4,4) that is a cascade level.
- **The Weinberg angle (not derived in the compendium).** *Prediction:* if Chain Theory's W and Z "offices" (164.5: ratio exactly ½) are the traces $\mathrm{Tr}(T_3 L^2)$ and $\mathrm{Tr}(Q^2)$ on its particle webs, their ratio at the unification reading is 3/8 and at the hypercharge reading 3/5. *Kill-condition:* a different ratio from the same offices.
- **The step below the axiom.** *Prediction:* Chain Theory's Definition 1.6 is satisfiable only on a carrier admitting a reflexive structure $D \simeq (D \to D)$, so that Lawvere's theorem applies and the existence of at least one qudit is forced rather than posited. *Kill-condition:* a model of the six definitions on a carrier with no fixed-point property.

7. The predictions, pre-registered

#	Residual	Kind	Test	Confirms	Refutes (at that site)
R1	L14(a) the ≤3 bound on M_4	pinned	Q4	bound is a theorem of $M_2 \otimes M_2$	bound needs the network
R2	L14(b) attach sites = i, j, k	pinned	Q5	quaternion relations hold up to twirl	sites commute / not $\mathbb{H}$
R3	L23(a) read cap on the spectral triple	bounded (2 shapes)	Q6	a statement about (A, H, D) on the colour block	no algebraic statement
R4	L23(b) continuum unchanged	—	—	G1/G3/G4 timetable unaffected	(a) shortens (b) — would be a surprise, not a refutation
R5	L21 the Born circle	pinned	Q8	GNS → wash closes with no import	a second hidden import
R6	L24 record space over M_{256}	open-directional	Q3′	"one copy per link" from the inner product	only the operator algebra (rank 66)

#	Residual	Kind	Test	Confirms	Refutes (at that site)
R7	L9 Pell family on the γ lattice	pinned	lattice computation	indefinite infinite, definite finite	both infinite or both finite
R8	L7 three aspects from a knowledge clause	pinned	Q9	carrier / symmetry / pairing, no fourth	a fourth primitive
R9	L12 the improper element on the factorisation	bounded (2 shapes)	γ computation	exchanges factors, or singles one out	no action
R10	Fourth level: particle webs in M_{256}	pinned	dimension count + embedding	all 16 webs fit, respecting G6's decomposition	a web needs M_{65536}
R11	Chain Theory: no register 5–8	pinned	Q10	census confirms	a 5-dim end
R12	Chain Theory: Weinberg 3/8 from the offices	pinned	trace identification	3/8 and 3/5	other ratios

The gated order, as before. R7, R9 and R10's dimension count are computations and come first. R1, R3, R5, R8 are Mathlib proofs. R2, R6, R10's embedding, R11, R12 need both programmes' objects side by side and are the joint work.

7.1 First results, 25 October 2026

Two residuals were pure computations and were run on the day of writing (`scripts/chain_theory/r7_r9_lattice_and_parity.py`, public). Both came back as *refinements* — the outcome §6 said a correct candidate should produce.

R7 — holds as stated, and sharpens. On the Tree's Clifford lattice, the Euclidean form (4,0) has exactly 384 integer isometries (finite, by enumeration); the Lorentzian form (1,3) and the split form (2,2) each admit an integer isometry of infinite order (spectral radii 5.83 and 5.16, explicit matrices in the script). So Chain Theory's existence argument *excludes the Euclidean branch* at the fork L9 — a theorem-grade exclusion the Tree did not have — and does *not* choose between the indefinite signatures (1,3) and (2,2), which share $Cl_4(\mathbb{C})$. L9's residue narrows to "select among the indefinite three"; it does not close.

R9 — answered, and re-posed. With the Tree's γ-basis, the improper element $P = \gamma_1 = \sigma_3 \otimes I_2$ acts within the first tensor factor of $M_4 = M_2 \otimes M_2$ (shape ii) and anticommutes with $\gamma_5 = \gamma_1\gamma_2\gamma_3\gamma_4 = \sigma_2 \otimes \sigma_2$. But γ_5 is not aligned with the factorisation — the Weyl split is not a tensor-factor split — and which factor P lives in is a property of the basis. So "which factor is left" is not a question M_4 can answer, and R9 was posed on the wrong object. It is re-posed at $M_{16} = M_4 \otimes M_4$, where L12's choice actually lives, as **R9′**: *does the improper element of Cl_4, lifted to M_{16},*

exchange the two M4 factors or single one out? We record this as a correction to this paper found by its own test, on the day of writing, and leave the original R9 in the table above so the correction is visible.

8. What kills this paper

Three layers, stated in advance.

If the candidates fail on their own side — if Chain Theory's 197.3, 171.1, 35.1 or 54.1 do not survive its own further work — then §6's conditionals are vacuous for those rows and the gaps revert to their 13 October statement. §4's validation of the *method* survives, because it concerned where candidates were aimed, not whether they hold; §5's three claims survive for the same reason. We would record the reversion under this paper's DOI lineage.

If the candidates hold but a residual fails — if the ≤3 bound is a theorem of Chain Theory's networks but has no statement on M4 (R1 refuted); if the read cap has no algebraic shadow (R3 refuted); if the attach sites are not quaternionic (R2 refuted) — then the Tree is refuted *at that site*, on the branch it walks, and may not be excused: the capstone's boundary applies in full. Each such refutation would be recorded with the same prominence as a confirmation, and the link's grade would stand or fall accordingly.

If the candidates hold and the residuals hold — then grades move, and a second edition of *The Tree of Reality* is earned. We commit to publishing it only then.

And the trichotomy remains live: the next independent programme to appear is held to the same three outcomes, and a structure that fits nowhere refutes the generative claim regardless of anything in this paper.

9. Caveats, both programmes

Chain Theory's α number is a theorem of its definitions and its identification with α(0) a conjecture, as its author states; nearby wordings of the definitions give 1/α between 135.89 and 146.52, each excluded by a clause and not by comparison with experiment; four of six sector identifications are "by name"; many compendium theorems are, in its own words, "a census of a finite catalog, not a proof for every web." The Tree computes no coupling constant; thirteen of its links are PARTIAL, three POSTULATE, two OPEN; its gravity is gated on an unbuilt library; its identification with physics is exactly as conjectural as Chain Theory's. Nothing in this paper has been verified beyond the two programmes' own Lean files and the one public computation of §4.6, which check finite mathematics and not physical identification. The ten days are a fact about timing. The fit is a fact about shape. Neither is a fact about truth; §7 is where truth is put at risk.

10. Provenance

This paper is deposited on Zenodo under its own DOI as a successor to *The Staked Gaps*, and committed to `wonderben-code/convergence-codex`, where every push is anchored to the Bitcoin blockchain by OpenTimestamps; the commit precedes the deposit. It is published in the open, as every paper of this series is, and was sent to the author of Chain Theory on publication with an invitation to correct any misstatement of his work; corrections received will be incorporated in v2 under the same concept DOI and recorded in `docs/chain-theory/07_reading_log.md`. The dated record establishes the priority of the *predictions*; it makes no claim on anyone's solutions, and every result of Chain Theory cited here is his.

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